

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



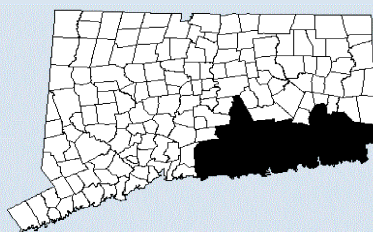
Learn

Salvatore Menzo, Superintendent • 860-434-4800

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	10
Enrollment	1,396
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$26,057
Total Expenditures ¹	\$36,741,055

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	717	51.4	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	112	8.0	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	529	37.9	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	182	13.0	4.7
White	531	38.0	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	112	8.0	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	815	58.4	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	257	18.4	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	93	21.6	25	3.6
Male	*	*	69	9.4
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	16	20.8	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	78	23.5	34	6.4
White	53	14.7	29	5.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	28	25.7	7	6.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	132	26.0	65	7.4
Students with Disabilities	62	28.2	38	12.8
District	176	19.3	94	6.6
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 216

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Learn

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	179.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	77.3
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	47.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	86.8
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	15.0
School Level	15.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	20.1
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	27.5
School Nurses	8.5
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	99.7

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.3	0.1
Asian	5	1.6	1.4
Black or African American	15	4.8	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	17	5.5	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	273	87.8	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	13.7	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	6	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	14	63.6	23	88.5
White	46	78.0	69	90.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	0	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	35	71.4	41	89.1
Students with Disabilities	*	*	13	50.0
District	79	73.8	108	89.3
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Learn

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.6
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.4
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.5
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	2.0
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$27,697,754	\$19,644	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$3,084,907	\$2,188	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$111,592	\$79	\$905
Support services - general administration	.	.	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$1,768,614	\$1,254	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$2,347,367	\$1,665	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$1,358,097	\$963	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$339,255	\$1,885	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$33,468	\$24	\$213
Total	\$36,741,055	\$26,057	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$4,411,947	28.0	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,570,582	16.3	10.2
Other Salaries	\$3,362,496	21.4	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,320,476	14.8	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$2,300,546	14.6	6.4
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.2
Supplies	\$173,407	1.1	0.7
Property Services	\$434,545	2.8	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	8.4
Equipment	\$152,846	1.0	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$2,089	0.0	0.1
Total	\$15,728,934	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		42.8	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	63.3
State	29.9
Federal	6.8
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Learn

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	38	50.2	38	44.1	19	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	142	50.9	142	49.6	56	52.5
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	57	62.8	56	54.1	29	61.4
White	123	62.8	123	58.1	78	73.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	51	44.4	51	42.9	15	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	317	59.1	316	54.4	172	63.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	229	51.9	229	47.4	108	53.2
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	139	65.4	138	61.7	79	74.9
Students with Disabilities	97	39.8	96	37.8	47	43.1
Students without Disabilities	271	63.2	271	58.1	140	68.8
High Needs	256	50.9	255	46.6	119	52.8
Non-High Needs	112	71.2	112	67.0	68	79.2
District	368	57.0	367	52.8	187	62.4

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	83.3	N/A	*	91.9	159	87.4
Curl Up	85.7	N/A	*	95.7	155	90.3
Push Up	74.7	N/A	N/A	79.7	152	77.0
Mile Run/PACER	72.6	N/A	*	50.7	156	62.2
All Tests - District	53.7	N/A	N/A	50.0	150	52.0
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Learn

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	8	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	24	87.5
White	63	95.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	53	90.6
Students with Disabilities	15	*
District	107	94.4
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	88	79.3
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*
Black or African American	7	*
Hispanic or Latino	32	66.7
White	102	75.6
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	59	62.1
Students with Disabilities	6	13.0
District	164	71.9
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

Copyright © 2024 The College Board. www.collegeboard.org

ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2024 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

Copyright © International Baccalaureate Organization 2024

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	76.7	82.1
Male	78.6	87.1
Non-Binary	*	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	66.7	*
White	79.0	90.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	73.5	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	76.7	84.3
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Learn

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	57.0	75	38.0	50	76.0	63.9
	High Needs Students	50.9	75	33.9	50	67.8	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	52.8	75	35.2	50	70.4	60.2
	High Needs Students	46.6	75	31.0	50	62.1	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	62.4	75	41.6	50	83.2	61.8
	High Needs Students	52.8	75	35.2	50	70.4	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	47.5%	100%	47.5	100	47.5	58.7%
	High Needs Students	45.7%	100%	45.7	100	45.7	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	54.7%	100%	54.7	100	54.7	61.4%
	High Needs Students	56.3%	100%	56.3	100	56.3	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	57.4%	100%	28.7	50	57.4	58.9%
	Oral	48.6%	100%	24.3	50	48.6	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	19.3%	<=5%	21.4	50	42.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	25.0%	<=5%	10.0	50	20.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	82.0%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	71.9%	75%	48.0	50	95.9	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		89.2%	94%	47.4	50	94.8	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		94.4%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		95.4%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		76.7%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		92.9% 52.0%	75%	34.7	50	69.3	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		33.4%	60%	27.8	50	55.7	55.0%
Accountability Index				1011.4	1450	69.8	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	71.2	50.9	20.3	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	67.0	46.6	20.4	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	52.8	22.2	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	95.4%	0.0%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.2
	High Needs Students	98.9
Math	All Students	99.0
	High Needs Students	98.5
Science	All Students	97.5
	High Needs Students	96.9

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Learn

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The vision of LEARN is to ensure that every child has access to high quality public education and opportunities through equitable systems of education, support, and service. To achieve this vision, LEARN bases its district improvement planning on the theory of action that if we consciously commit to a social justice stance, develop equity-focused systems, and eliminate inequitable practices, then we will be able to provide equitable access to and opportunities for all students and staff to be successful.

As a mechanism to support continuous improvement, each school utilizes a school development plan. Plans are developed by leadership teams in consultation with all school stakeholders. LEARN school development plans are based on needs assessment data, aligned to overarching district goals, and strive toward the development of school communities that provide physical and emotional safety, high expectations with a growth mindset, and approaches to instruction that foster engaging learning opportunities. The plans clearly articulate action steps and measurable outcomes that directly support every educator's ability to deliver high quality instruction. Schools utilize "coherence planning" to outline the new learning and action steps that occur through the year. Leading indicators of progress enable schools to monitor their progress throughout the school year. Data meetings, short-term goal review cycles, and district retreats engage leaders in reflection on the impact of their plans and any necessary adjustments that are necessary.

LEARN teams also work collaboratively with Local Education Agencies (LEAS) to design and implement appropriate special education services to implement students' Individualized Education Plans (IEPS). The development of IEP objectives are based on standards and individual student needs. Data collection systems are designed and implemented in order to inform progress, make revisions to the IEP, and determine supports and services to ensure all learners have access to a Free Appropriate Public Education (FAPE). To ensure all students have the supports they need, interventions for learning and behavior are designed and closely monitored on a systematic basis. Planning and Placement Teams include LEARN administrators, student support staff, parents, and the LEA. All parents and caregivers of children with disabilities have access to LEARN's Student Support Services (SSS) Department. LEARN SSS staff members meet regularly to receive relevant professional development, analyze case studies, and interact in a rich professional learning community.

LEARN is committed to enhancing and strengthening home-school communication and to providing avenues for parental and caregiver involvement. Each LEARN school provides different avenues of communication for families, including handbooks, newsletters, conferences, visitation days, back to school nights, town hall forums, PowerSchool Parent Portal, and School Messenger which translates messages into the language families identify as their primary language during registration. Importantly, LEARN also utilizes a two-way multilingual communication tool as an added way to strengthen the feedback and communication loop. All parents and caregivers are encouraged to participate in school level committees to support planning and improvement of school-based programs.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

LEARN, on behalf of districts across the region, successfully serves students from preschool through 12th grade from diverse districts through its four successful magnet schools located on the shoreline of southeastern Connecticut: Regional Multicultural Magnet School (K-5); The Friendship School (PK); Marine Science Magnet High School of Southeastern Connecticut (9-12); and Three Rivers Middle College Magnet High School (11 & 12). Together, these magnet schools serve over 1,300 students, increasing student achievement in racially, ethnically, and socioeconomically diverse communities.

As a magnet operator, LEARN's schools were created, in part, to address the significant opportunity and achievement gaps that exist within Connecticut's communities. Drawing from multiple communities, LEARN's students are brought together to learn with and from one another in diverse classrooms. LEARN schools engage students in culturally relevant curriculum and instructional practices while building strong relationships with and among students and staff. All LEARN school engage in professional learning about personal identity, culturally relevant teaching practices, and more. LEARN schools and central office staff also engage in continual self-reflection on ways to dismantle practices that may result in racial, ethnic, and economic isolation.

As a RESC, LEARN also engages in multiple U.S. Department of Education Magnet School Assistance Program [MSAP] grants. These grants expand student choice through the development and support of a consortia of interdistrict magnet schools across Eastern Connecticut. These grants reduce minority group and socio-economic isolation throughout the region, as well as increasing student achievement in the participating schools over a 5 year grant period. These grants provide vital funding and monitored outcomes that promote ongoing professional learning, the creation of systemic and equitable practices, and ongoing school improvement planning centered through a commitment to equitable opportunities and outcomes for all students.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Learn

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

LEARN's schools receive funding from the State Department of Education on a per pupil basis. In addition, each participating district contributes tuition fees. The schools also solicit funds from foundations and grant dollars to supplement educational components. Each school budget is developed by school administration in collaboration with LEARN's central office team. LEARN established the Regional Magnet Advisory Council, which includes Superintendents and district and college leaders from sending towns, to provide input, oversight and to recommend actions to LEARN's Board of Directors. Each school budget is reviewed and approved by LEARN's Board, which is composed of representative members of the Boards of Education of LEARN's member districts, to ensure that each school receives an equitable share. In addition to state and local funding sources, LEARN schools also leverage grants such as Title I. The participating schools have the autonomy and authority to allocate resources where they are most needed. Each school is required to consider student learning and social-emotional needs as key priorities, and to develop systems of support to ensure all students thrive.